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Zscaler sets a 2031 goal and sizes its data security business

Okta says its agent gateway is generally available, Anthropic picks CrowdStrike and Palo Alto Networks for a critical-infrastructure programme, and Proofpoint offers credits on qualifying platform commitments until 31 December.

SECURE EDGE

Zscaler sets a 2031 goal and sizes its data security business

- **Zscaler kept its guidance** at its 6 October Investor Day.
- **Zscaler's finance chief described a path** to more than $8 billion of annual recurring revenue by fiscal 2031.
- **Zscaler put its data security business above $400 million,** without calling it recurring revenue. It said 70% of its AI-security deals in its fiscal fourth quarter included data security.
- **Our view:** buyers appear to take data security alongside AI security from the same platform.

SOURCES Zscaler, 6 Oct · MarketBeat, 6 Oct

IDENTITY

Okta says its Agent Gateway is now generally available

- **Okta's blog on 8 October** says Agent Gateway "is Generally Available today". Okta had planned it for the third quarter.
- **The gateway checks** AI agents' calls to outside tools against policy and keeps one audit trail.
- **Still "coming soon":** a kill switch that cuts off an agent's access through the gateway.
- **Our view:** controls for agents' tool calls keep arriving inside larger products.

SOURCES Okta, 23 Sep and 8 Oct

AI COMPANIES

Anthropic names CrowdStrike and Palo Alto Networks among 11 partners

- **Anthropic launched a programme** to help defend critical infrastructure such as power and water. CrowdStrike and Palo Alto Networks are among 11 founding partners.
- **Microsoft, Cisco and SentinelOne** are not among the partners. Anthropic's announcement gives no amounts or contract values.
- **Anthropic also expanded** its access programme for cyber-capable models. Its Defense tier is for security teams defending their own systems.
- **Our view:** for a second week, an AI company is acting as a route to customers for large security platforms.

SOURCES Anthropic, 6 and 8 Oct · CrowdStrike, 8 Oct · SecurityWeek, 9 Oct

HOW PLATFORMS SELL

Proofpoint and Netskope change how customers buy from them

- **Proofpoint Flex:** customers commit to Proofpoint as a platform and can move spend between its products each year.
- **Until 31 December,** qualifying commitments earn credits for new Proofpoint products "at no additional cost", Proofpoint says.
- **Netskope** now sells its AI agents from one shared pool of credits, available today, it says.
- **Our view:** Proofpoint is targeting the renewal, where specialists usually lose deals. Netskope's credits make adding its agents easier.

SOURCES Proofpoint, 5 Oct · Netskope, 6 Oct

IDENTITY

SailPoint announces controls for AI agents

- **At Navigate on 6 October,** SailPoint announced agents that watch AI agents, discovery of the tools they use, and an agent kill switch.
- **SailPoint says the features are "rolling out".** Three items are expected in its fiscal fourth quarter, which by our reading runs November to January.
- **Customers are "slated to get"** the Entro integration in November, SiliconANGLE reports.
- **SailPoint gave no prices.**

SOURCES SailPoint, 6 Oct · SiliconANGLE, 9 Oct

FUNDING

Keyfactor closes $1 billion-plus growth funding

- **Keyfactor** closed the $1 billion-plus growth investment led by Summit Partners that it announced in July.
- **Hadrian raised $40 million and Rein Security $25 million.** Both build security for or with AI agents.
- **Palo Alto Networks' chief executive** said the company can wait for the winners in agent security and buy them, CTech reports.
- **Q3 funding:** $5.26 billion in disclosed funding across 104 rounds, the most in a quarter since early 2022, Pinpoint Search Group reports.

SOURCES Keyfactor, 5 Oct · SecurityWeek, 7 and 8 Oct · CTech, 7 Oct · Pinpoint Search Group, 6 Oct

MORE BUSINESS MOVES

Other moves to keep in view

INSIDER RISK

Securonix says its behaviour analytics for AI agents are available now.

DATA SECURITY

Microsoft now plans general availability of Purview data loss prevention for non-Microsoft apps for late October, not early September.

IDENTITY

Forcepoint and BeyondTrust say a joint feature is available now to revoke a risky identity's access to sensitive data.

SECURITY OPERATIONS

Elastic announced an agent layer, with a technical preview "upcoming" and availability "soon", it says.

SECURE EDGE

Cato Networks hired a new chief revenue officer from outside the company.

ACQUISITIONS

CyberFOX bought Optimize365. We found no acquisition by a large platform vendor.

STORIES TO WATCH

What we are watching next

DEAL TALKS

Proofpoint and Varonis: reported talks remain unconfirmed after 38 days.

DATA SECURITY

Proofpoint's SOC Analyst Agent (SOC: security operations centre): we found no newer statement after its end-of-September target.

SECURE EDGE

Netskope Agent Action Control: promised for the end of its current quarter.

IDENTITY

Okta's gateway kill switch: "coming soon". SailPoint investor webcast on 14 October.

RESULTS

Fortinet reports on 28 October; Check Point on 2 November.

SOURCES

Sources

Company announcements, regulatory filings and reporting behind this week's stories.

COMPANY AND PRIMARY ANNOUNCEMENTS

Zscaler · Okta · Anthropic · CrowdStrike · Proofpoint · Netskope · SailPoint · Keyfactor · Pinpoint Search Group · Securonix · Microsoft · Forcepoint · Elastic · Cato Networks · SEC · Fortinet · Check Point

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Full sources accompany the weekly summary.